CloudNote AI

User Manual: videos that remember each other

How to use every page and feature of the live CloudNote AI web app, how it works on AWS, and what to do when something goes wrong.

Live app: **https://d349qer3boe6fg.cloudfront.net**
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Manual edition 2, October 2026. Every screenshot was taken from the live deployment.

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> **About the sample videos.** The four sample videos (Server Setup, Application Setup Tutorial, Database Tutorial, Monitoring and Alerts) are small invented transcripts made to show the features. Their content, timestamps and links are illustrative, not measured results.

1. What CloudNote AI does

CloudNote AI turns recorded lectures, meetings and tutorials into notes you can search and question. Upload a video or audio file, or import a transcript, and CloudNote AI will:

- **Transcribe** the recording with Amazon Transcribe into timestamped moments.
- **Write notes**: a summary, key points, action items and decisions. Every item links to the moment it came from.
- **Answer questions** from your notes, with numbered citations you can click.
- **Connect recordings**: when one video says "as we discussed earlier", it suggests where another video explains it (Context Recovery).
- **Remember gaps**: if nothing explains a reference yet, it can keep checking every new upload and notify you once when something matches.
- **Track follow-ups**: phrases like "in the next video we will cover..." are tracked until a later video covers them.
- **Map your library**: which videos depend on which, a suggested watch order and a gaps report.

Each user only ever sees their own library.

> We found no existing tool that combines cross-video reference recovery with remembered, re-checked gaps in this way. That is our observation from the tools we reviewed, not a claim that none exists.

2. Getting started

Create an account

1. Open **https://d349qer3boe6fg.cloudfront.net**.
2. Click **Create an account** under the sign-in form.
3. Enter your email and a password of at least 8 characters that includes a number, then submit. You are signed in straight away; there is no confirmation email.

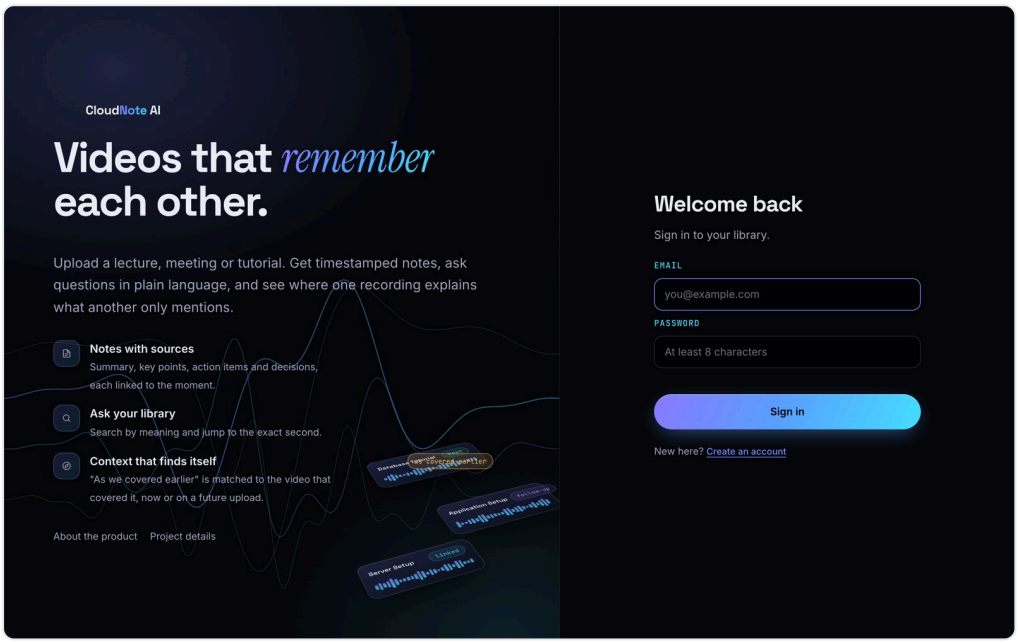


Figure 1. The sign-in page. New users click **Create an account**.

Try it with sample videos

A new library is empty. Click **Try with sample videos** to add two sample videos (Server Setup and Application Setup Tutorial). The **Library** page offers the other two (Database Tutorial, Monitoring and Alerts). Samples cost nothing: they skip transcription.



Figure 2. The first screen after signing up.

3. Home and Library

Home greets you, offers a quick question box and shows your library at a glance: number of videos, hours indexed, searchable moments and open items. **Needs your attention** lists references that may now be answered and follow-ups still waiting.

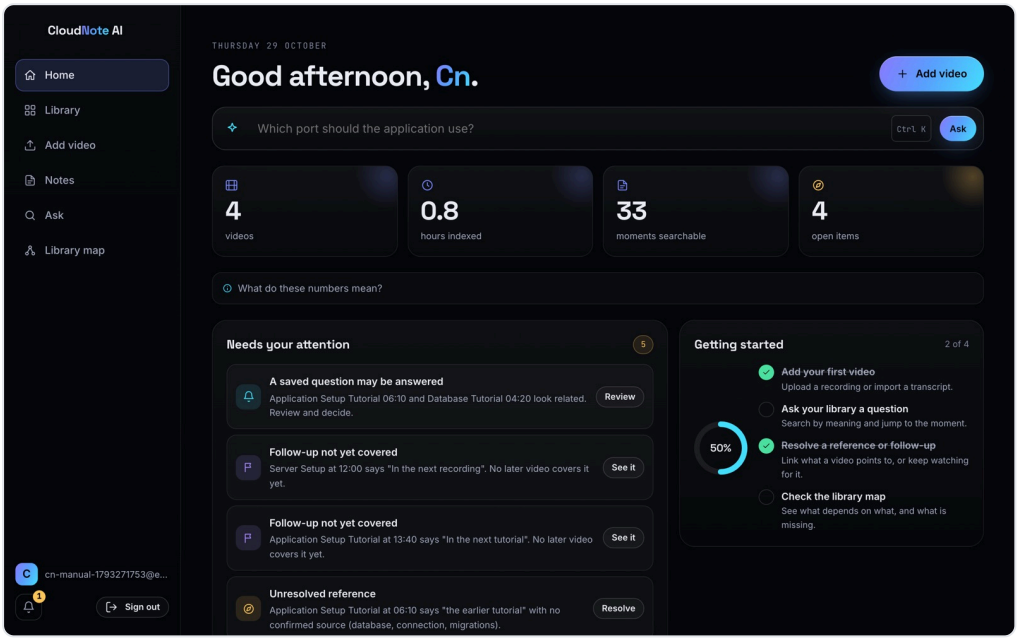


Figure 3. Home with the sample videos loaded.

Library shows every video as a card with cover art, status and length. Use the filters and search box to narrow the list, and the sample buttons to add the remaining sample videos.

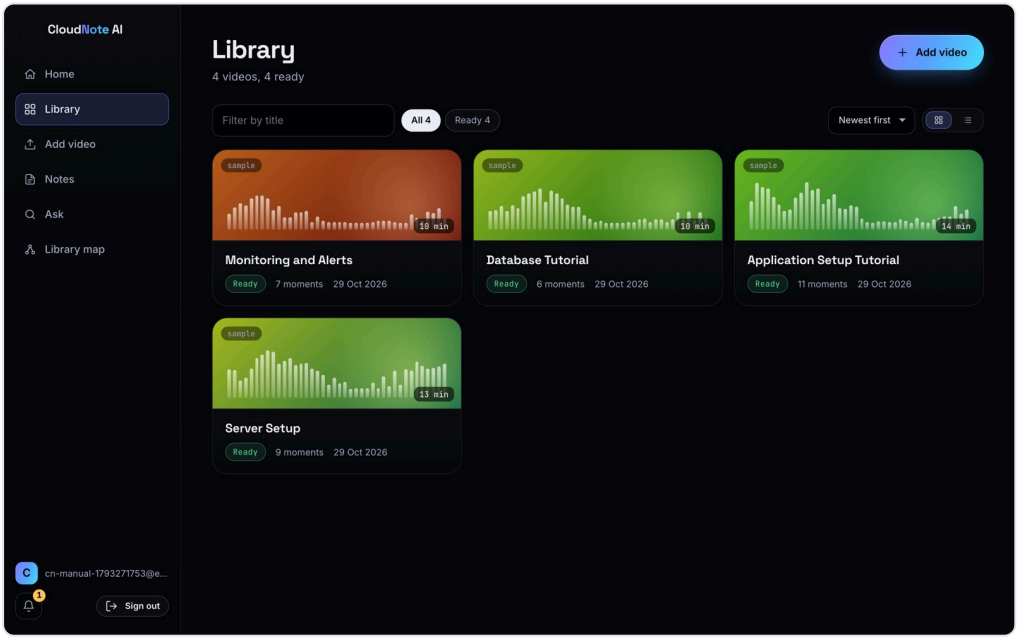


Figure 4. The Library with all four sample videos.

4. Adding videos and transcripts

Open **Add video**. There are two ways to add a recording:

Option	What to provide	What happens
Media file	mp4, m4a, mp3, wav, flac, ogg, webm or amr, up to 500 MB. Choose the spoken language.	The file uploads straight to private storage (Amazon S3), Amazon Transcribe converts the speech to text, and the notes are generated. A short clip takes about a minute.
Transcript	SRT, WebVTT, Amazon Transcribe JSON or plain text, pasted or typed.	Notes are generated right away. No transcription cost.

Languages: English (US, India, UK), Hindi, Telugu, Spanish, French and German. Each user can keep up to 30 videos.

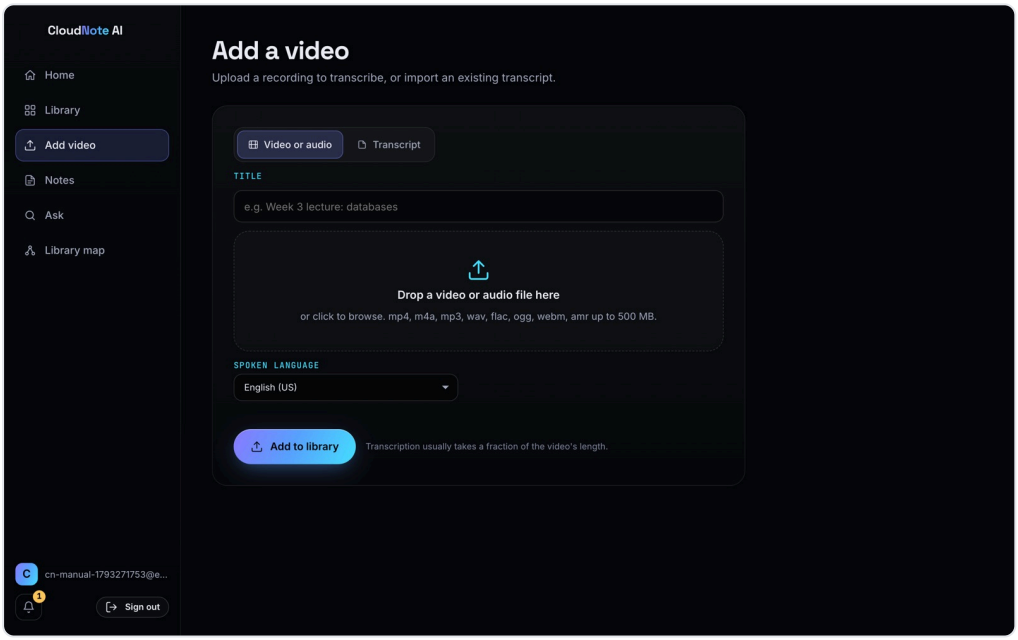


Figure 5. The Add video page.

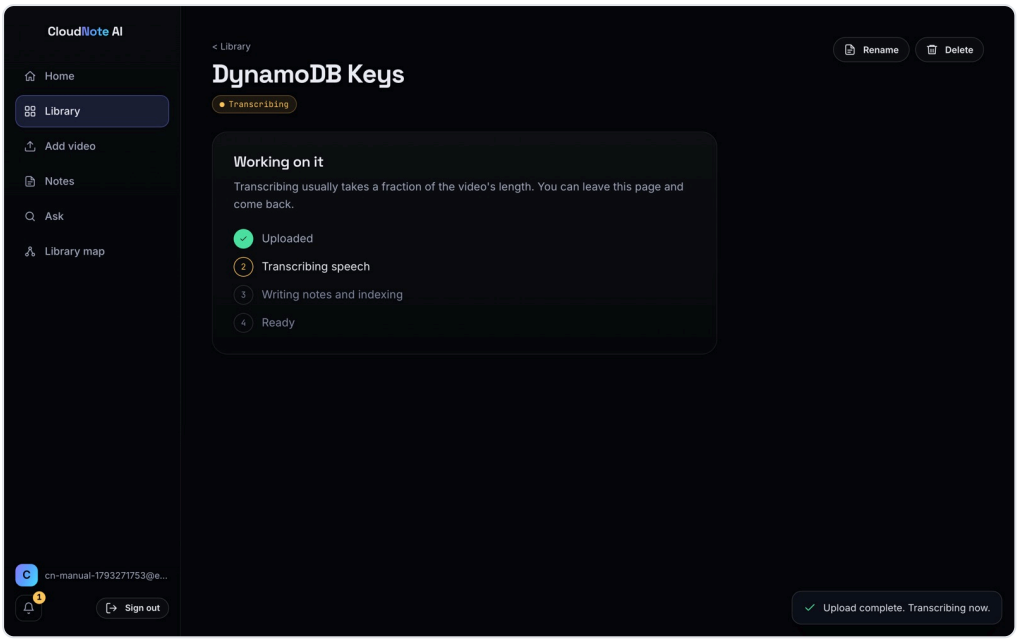


Figure 6. While Amazon Transcribe works, the video page shows progress and fills in by itself when done.

5. The video page

Open any video from the Library. The left side has the player (or a note for imported transcripts), the **Moments** timeline and the full transcript with its own search box. Click any timestamp to jump the player to that moment.

The header shows the status, length, number of moments and how the notes were made: **AI notes** or **extractive notes**. The buttons **Rename**, **Reprocess** (regenerate notes) and **Delete** are at the top right.

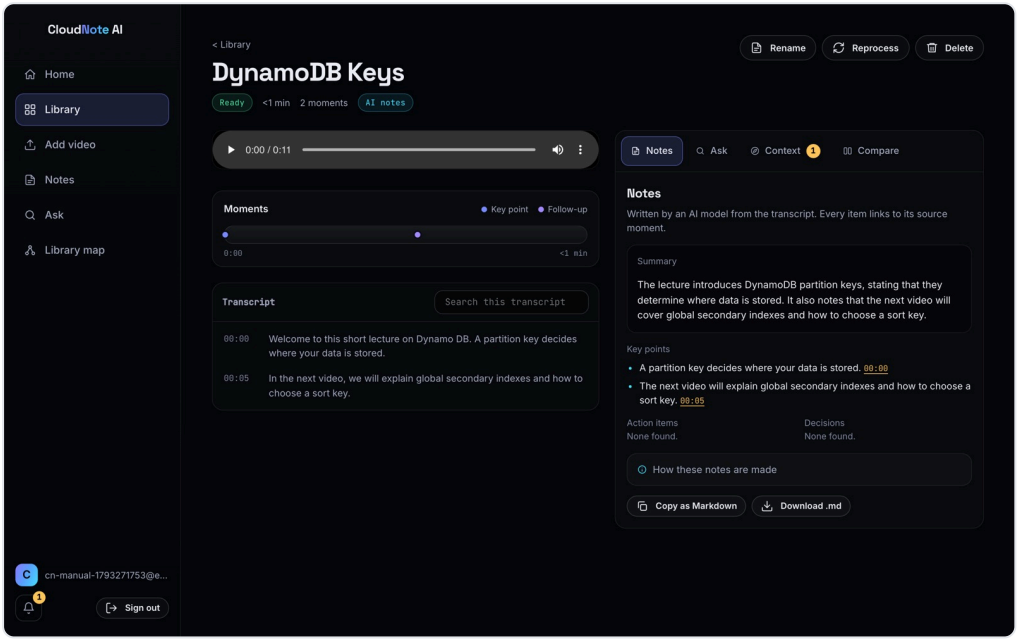


Figure 7. A real 11-second speech clip after Amazon Transcribe and AI notes on the live site. The follow-up "In the next video..." was detected automatically.

The four tabs

Tab	Use it to
Notes	Read the summary, key points, action items and decisions. **Copy as Markdown** and **Download .md** export them.
Ask	Find the moments in this video that answer a question.
Context	See references to other videos ("as discussed earlier") and their suggested sources. See section 8.
Compare	Paste your own notes to see which key points you covered, which may be wrong and which you missed. **Add to my notes** copies a missed point into your notes.

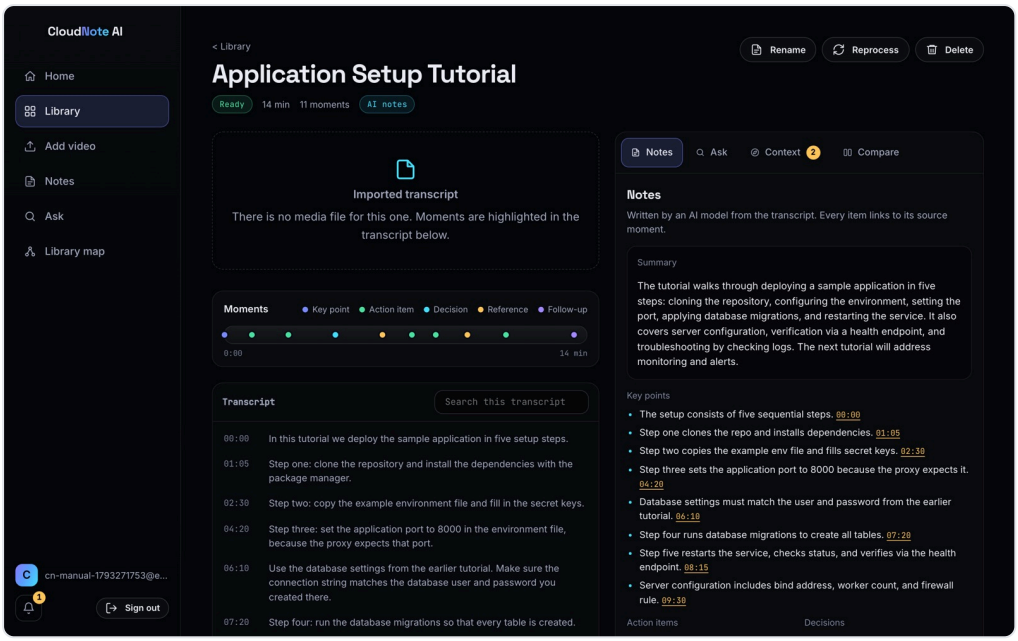


Figure 8. The Notes tab of the Application Setup Tutorial sample.

5. The video page (continued)

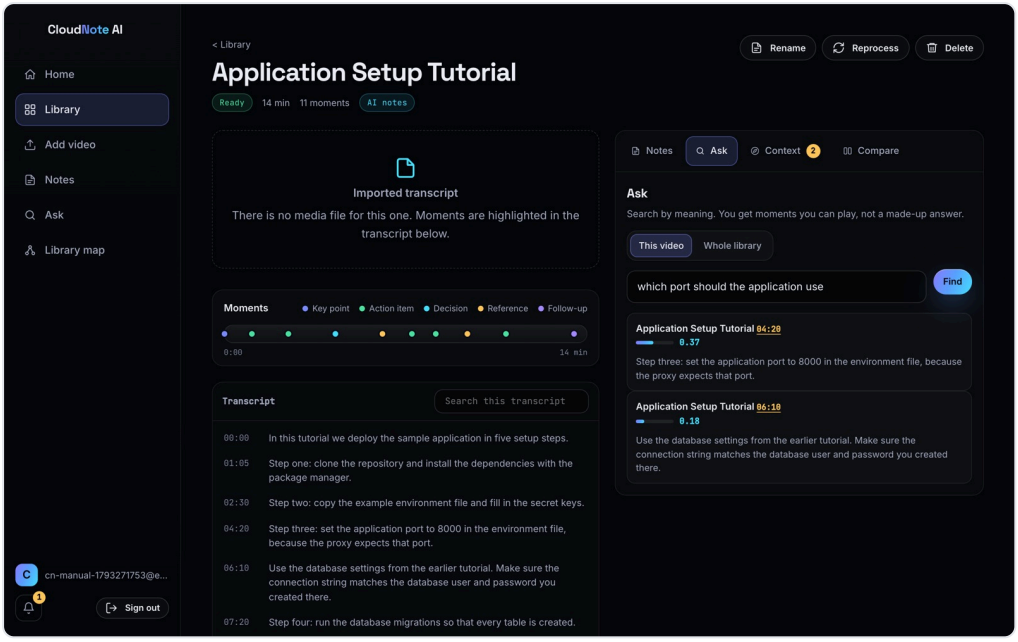


Figure 9. The Ask tab finds the moments in this video that answer a question.

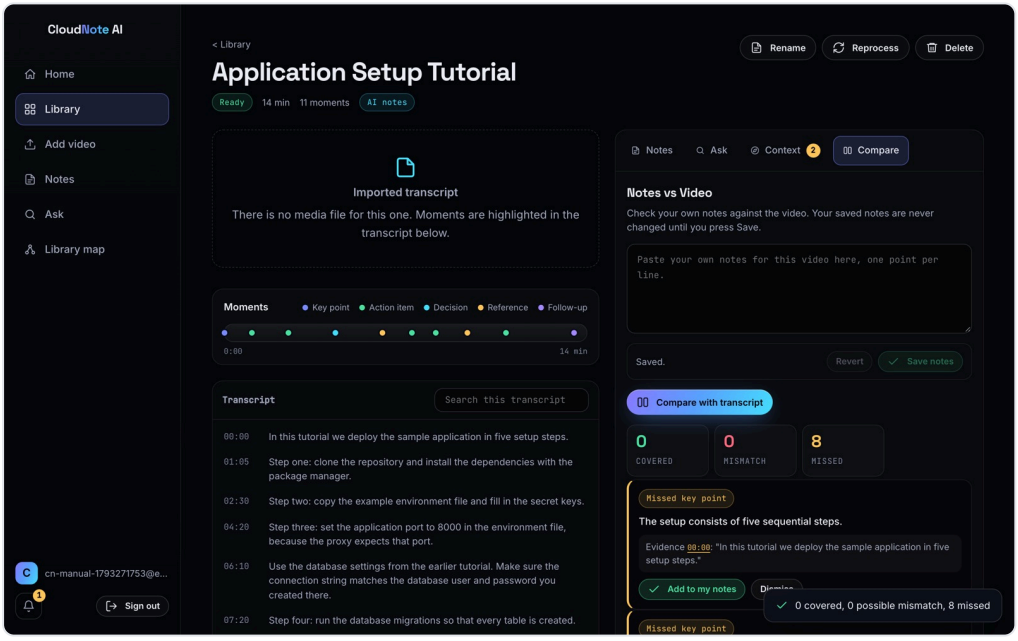


Figure 10. The Compare tab checks your own notes against the video's key points.

6. Notes and ask-your-notes

The **Notes** page collects the notes of every ready video as compact cards. Filter them with the box at the top, or open a card to read it full page. The reader (`#/notes/<video>`) has its own search box for searching inside that note.

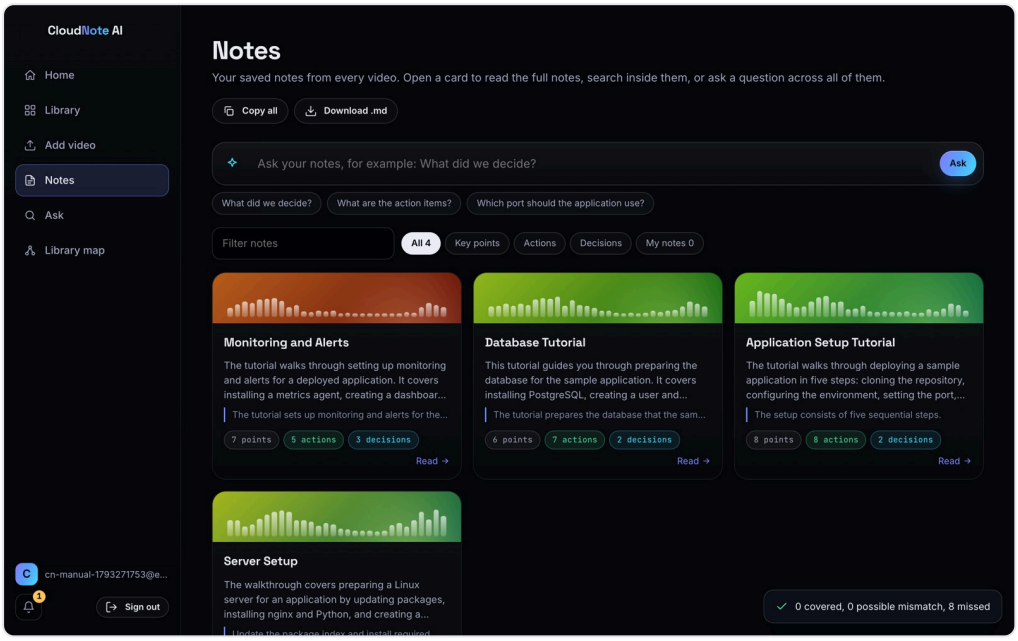


Figure 11. The Notes page.

Ask your notes

Type a question in **Ask your notes**, or click a suggested question. The AI answers **only from your notes** and cites the passages it used with numbers like [1]. The sources are listed under the answer with links to their moments. When your notes do not cover the question, it says so and shows the closest notes instead of guessing.

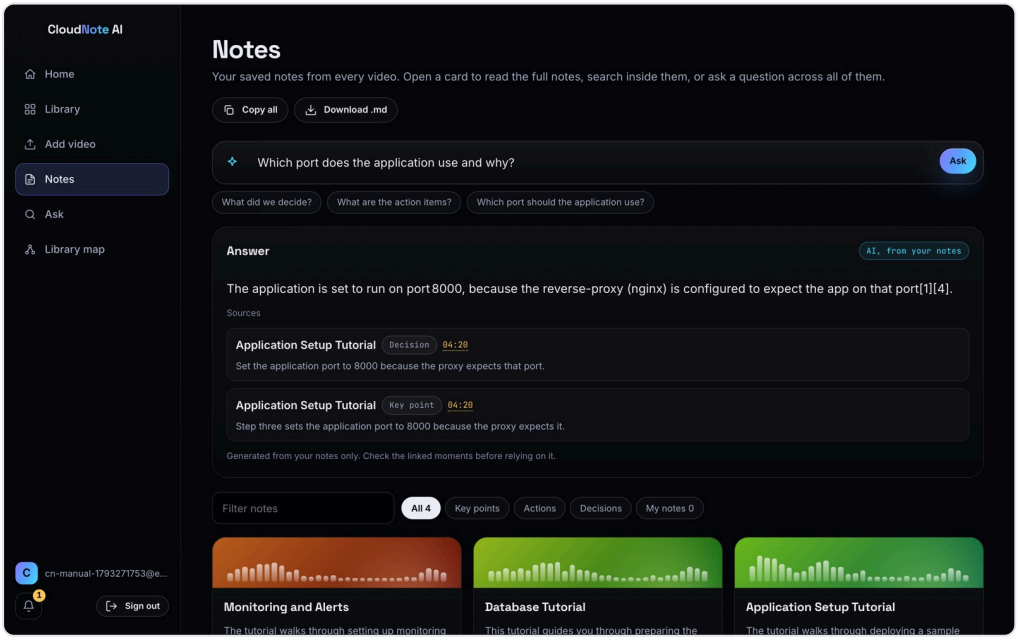


Figure 12. An AI answer with citations, built from the sample notes.

6. Notes (continued) and 7. Ask

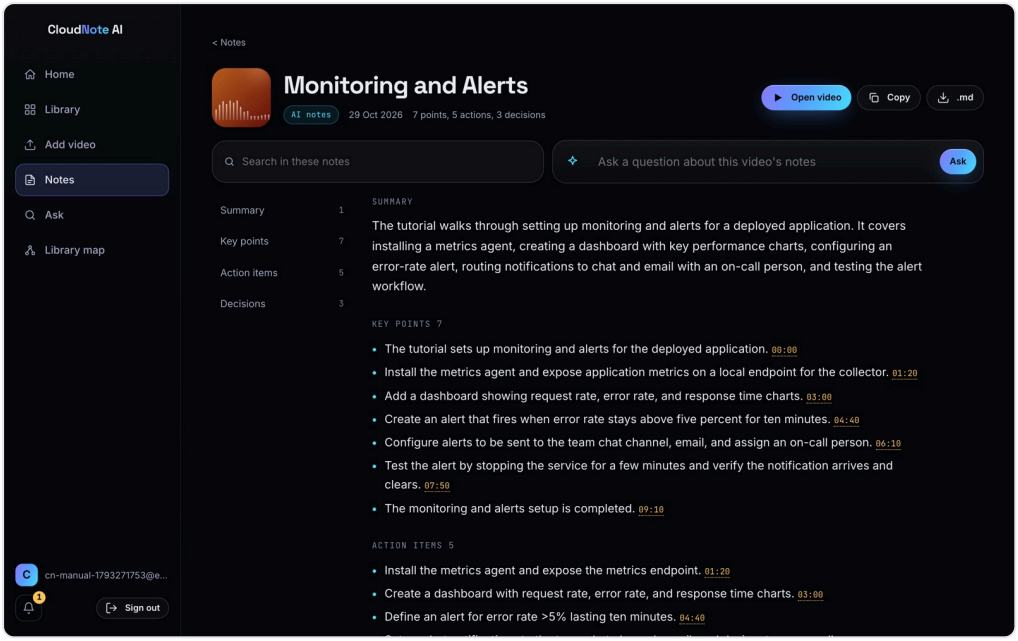


Figure 13. The full-page note reader.

7. Ask: searching your library

The **Ask** page searches every transcript in your library and returns playable moments, best match first. It is the fastest way to find where something was said.

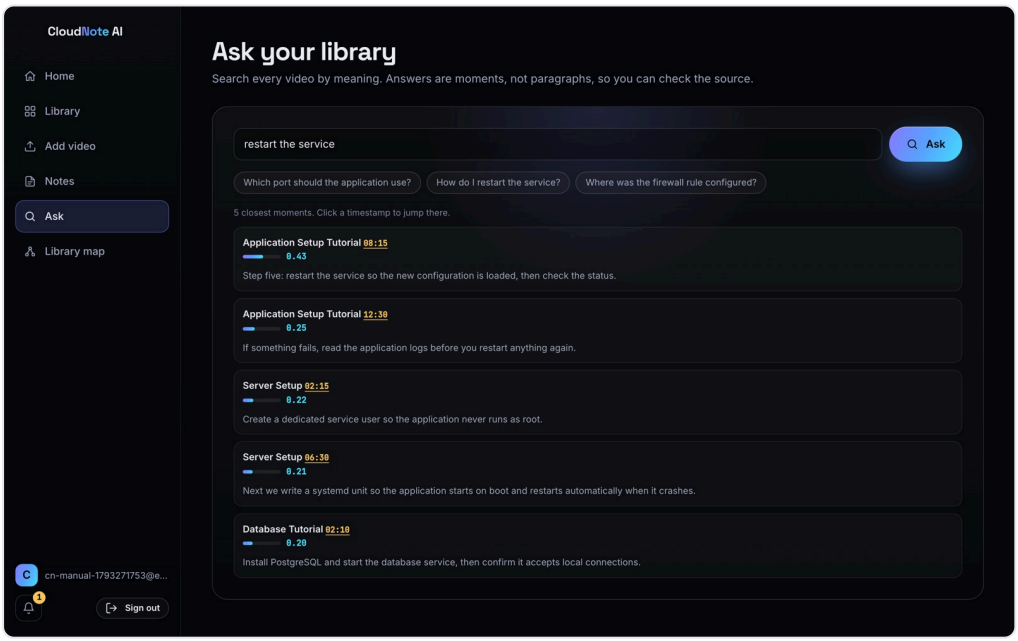


Figure 14. Ask returns matching moments across all videos.

8. Context Recovery, remembered references and notifications

Recordings often lean on each other: "use the database settings from the earlier tutorial". The **Context** tab lists these references, each with its moment and the best candidate explanations from your other videos.

- **Accept this source** links the reference to that explanation.
- **Leave unresolved and remember it** keeps the reference as a saved question. CloudNote AI re-checks it every time you add a video.

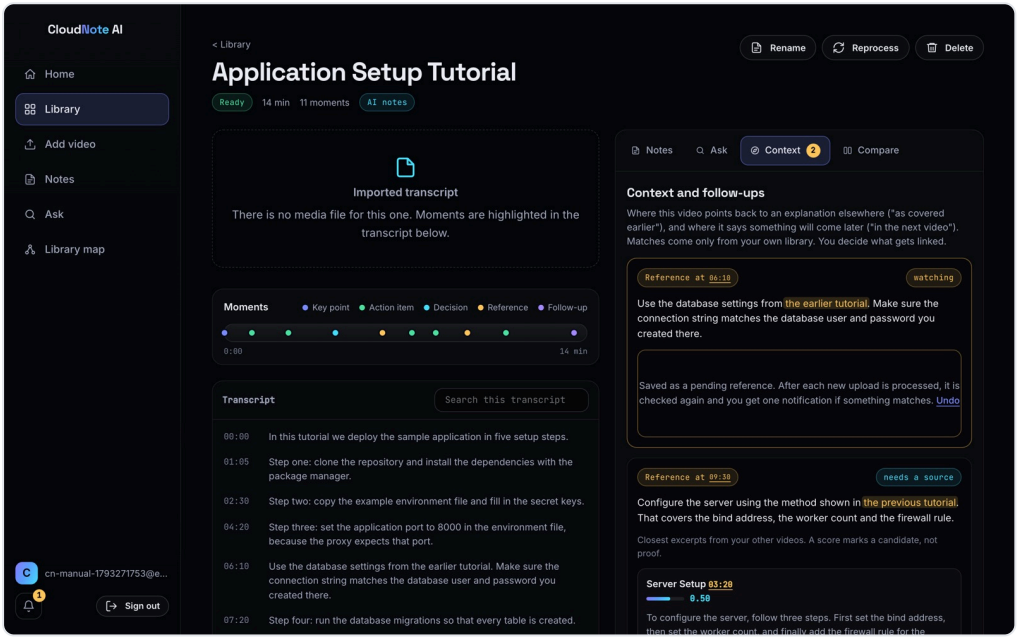


Figure 15. The Context tab with references found in the Application Setup Tutorial.

Remember the Missing Explanation

When a new video explains a remembered reference, the bell shows a badge and the notification panel offers the match **once**. Accept it to create the link, or dismiss it.

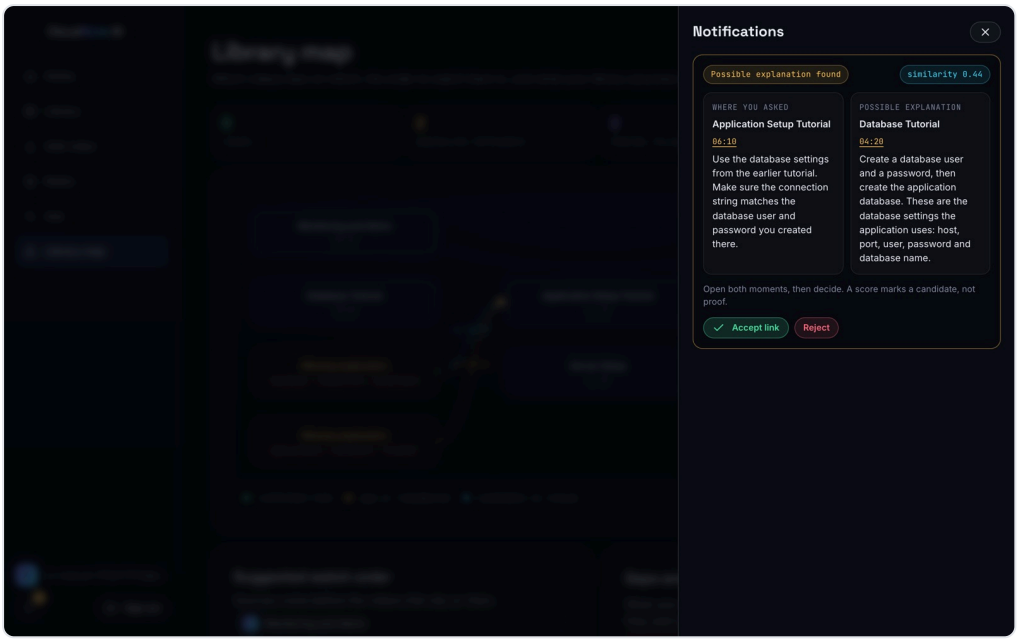


Figure 16. After the database reference was remembered, adding the Database Tutorial produced this notification.

9. Follow-ups and the Library map

A **follow-up** is a forward reference such as "in the next video we will explain indexes". CloudNote AI tracks each one until a later video covers it, and lists those still waiting on Home and in the gaps report.

The **Library map** draws your videos and the links between them: confirmed links, gaps (missing explanations and follow-ups not yet covered) and candidates to review. Below the map are a **suggested watch order** (sources before the videos that rely on them) and a **gaps and follow-ups report** you can copy.

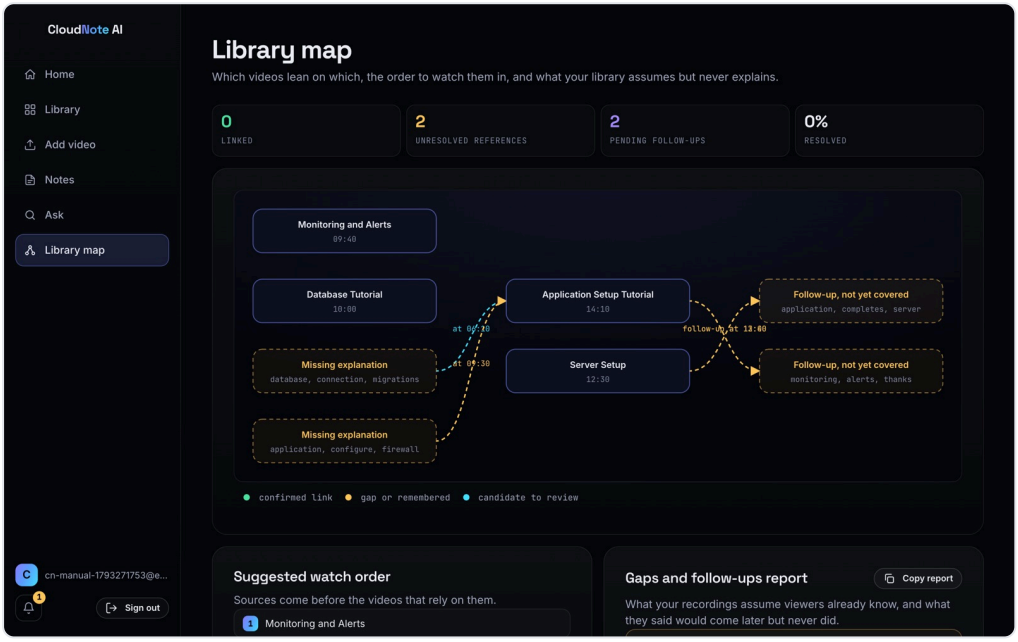


Figure 17. The Library map for the sample videos.

10. Command bar and mobile

Press `Ctrl` + `K` (`Cmd` + `K` on a Mac) anywhere to open the command bar. Type to find a video or page, move with the arrow keys and press `Enter`. `Esc` closes it.

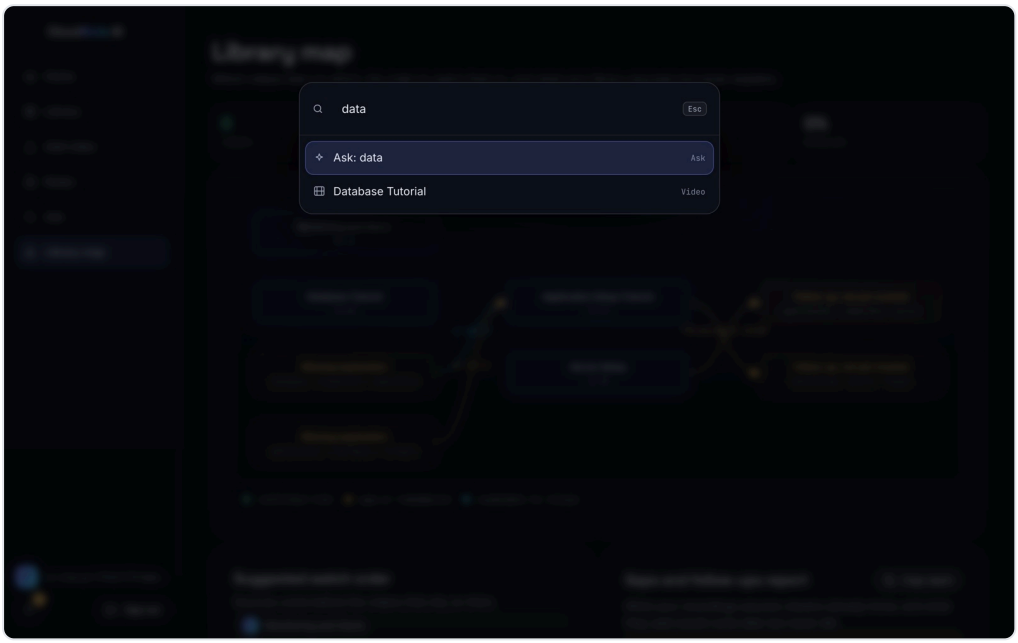


Figure 18. The command bar.

On a phone the side menu becomes a bottom tab bar (Home, Library, Notes, Ask, Map), and the bell and sign-out move to the top.

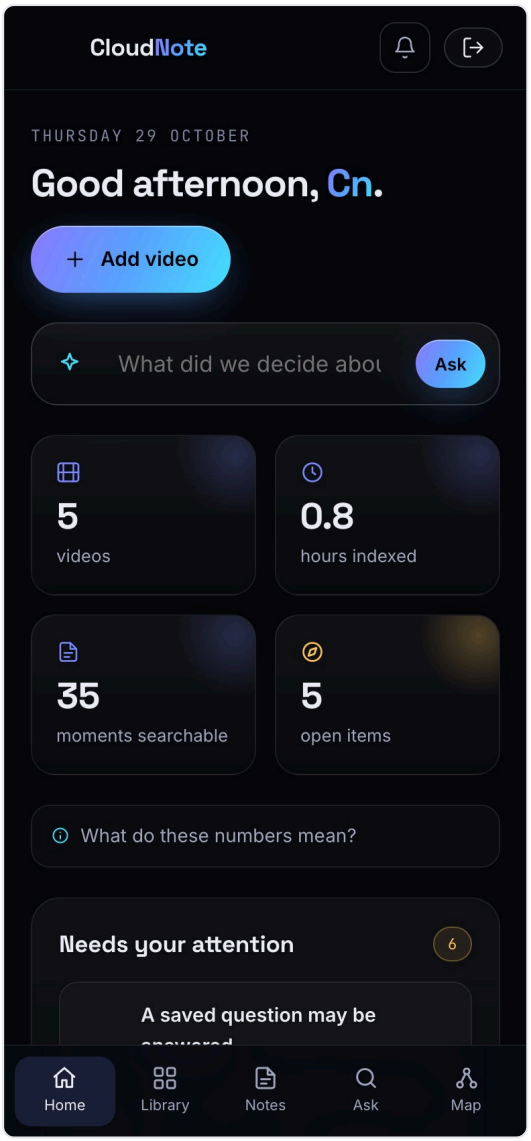


Figure 19. Home on a phone-sized screen.

11. How it works

CloudNote AI is fully serverless on AWS: nothing runs while no one uses it.

Part	AWS service	Role
Website	S3 + CloudFront	Serves the app over HTTPS; `/api/*` goes to the API.
Sign-in	Amazon Cognito	Accounts and tokens; the API rejects requests without a valid token.
API	API Gateway (HTTP API) + Lambda	All app requests.
Data	DynamoDB	Videos, transcripts, notes, references, notifications (one table).
Media	S3 (private)	Uploads and playback through short-lived signed links.
Speech to text	Amazon Transcribe + EventBridge	Transcribes uploads; EventBridge wakes the worker Lambda when a job finishes.
AI notes and answers	Amazon Bedrock, with free fallbacks	See below.

Which AI writes the notes

The backend tries each model in order and uses the first one that answers:

1. **Amazon Bedrock** (Amazon Nova Lite), the intended model.
2. **Groq** free tier (`openai/gpt-oss-120b`).
3. **Google Gemini** free tier (`gemini-3.8-flash`).
4. Built-in extractive notes (key sentences from the transcript) if no model answers.

> **Current status (October 2026).** The AWS account is new, and Bedrock allows it 0 tokens per day for now. Notes and answers on the live site therefore come from **Groq**, and library search is keyword based instead of meaning based. Bedrock takes over automatically when AWS raises the quota. Transcription always uses Amazon Transcribe.

12. Limits, privacy and troubleshooting

Limits

- Up to 30 videos per user and 500 MB per file. One spoken language per upload.
- No password reset yet, and sign-up does not verify email addresses.
- Media links expire after a while; reload the page if playback stops.

Privacy

- Your videos and notes are private to your account.
- While Groq or Gemini writes the notes, transcript text is sent to that provider. Do not upload confidential recordings.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Sign-up is rejected	Use a password of 8+ characters with a number. If the site limits sign-up to certain email domains, use an allowed address.
Header says **extractive notes**	No AI model answered when the notes were made, for example because a provider was busy. Click **Reprocess** later.
Video stuck on transcribing	Short clips finish in about a minute. After 30 minutes the video can be started again. Check that the file has speech in the chosen language.
"The upload did not finish"	Upload the file again; keep the tab open until the upload completes.
Ask your notes finds nothing	The AI only answers from your notes. Rephrase with words used in the video, or check that the video's notes are ready.
Playback stops	The signed media link expired. Reload the page.

13. For maintainers

Source layout, tests and full deployment steps are in `README.md` and `docs/DEPLOY.md`. In short:

Task	Command
Build	`node build.mjs`
Run locally (no AWS)	`DATA_DIR=/tmp/cn-data node backend/local-server.mjs`, then open http://localhost:8787
Tests	`node --test tests/engine.test.mjs backend/tests/*.test.mjs`
Deploy or update	`bash infra/deploy.sh us-east-1` with the options in docs/DEPLOY.md
Remove everything	`bash infra/destroy.sh us-east-1`

Lessons from the first deploy

- `aws cloudformation package` ignores `Globals.CodeUri`; each function needs its own `CodeUri`.
- New AWS accounts on the Free plan cannot use Amazon Transcribe; the paid plan (which keeps remaining credits) is required.
- Bedrock on a new account may have a 0 tokens per day quota; ask AWS Support for an increase, and use the free fallbacks meanwhile.
- Model failures are logged in CloudWatch as `model failed, trying the next one`; replies the app cannot use are logged as `ask: reply had no usable citations`.

Security checklist

- Set `ALLOWED_EMAIL_DOMAINS` to limit sign-up, and keep an AWS Budgets alert on the account.
- Never commit AWS, Groq or Gemini keys. Delete the deploy access key when deployments are finished.